

MALLOREDDUS

Pasta, Missy Robbins

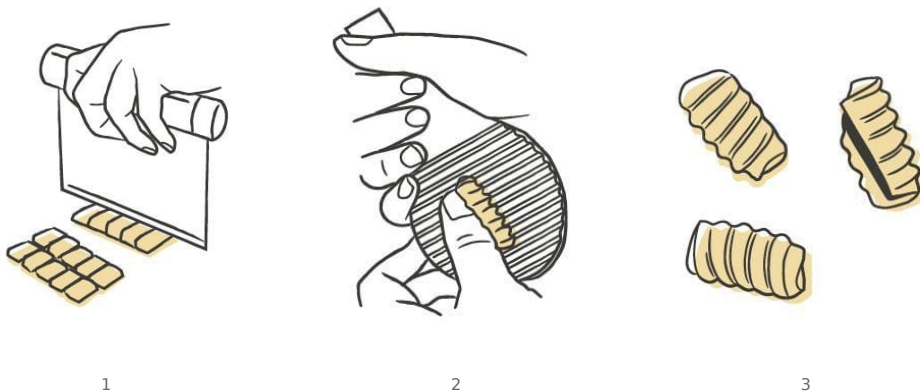
DETAILS

- Dough: egg-dough, semolina-dough
- Region: Sardinia, in the south near Cagliari

METHOD

1. Make an egg-based or semolina dough. Dust a wooden board with a little 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
2. Quarter the dough. Work one piece and keep the rest under plastic wrap or a towel.
3. Press the piece into a thick rope by hand. Set the fingertips of both hands together at its midpoint, then roll back and forth while walking your hands apart toward the ends.
4. Keep rolling under light pressure until the rope is about 1/2 inch across, roughly as thick as a Sharpie. Cut it in half and roll the halves separately if it gets too long to handle.
5. Cut the rope into 3/4-inch pieces with a knife or bench scraper. Cover the pieces you are not shaping.
6. Press a piece into the ridged board with your thumb and drag it down the surface, rolling your thumb out and away from you as you go. The piece curls into a small shell with ribs on the outside. Work through the rest of the cut pieces.
7. Lay the finished pasta on the sheet pan in a single layer.
8. Repeat from step 3 with the remaining dough.
9. To hold it, wrap the pan in plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



NOTES

Dimensions run 1/2-inch rope cut into 3/4-inch pieces. Sizes vary in Sardinia from about the length of a peanut shell down to a fingernail.

Needs a ridged surface for the thumb drag. A malloreddus or gnocchi board is the usual one; a fork's back, a cheese grater, or a bamboo mat all substitute. The ribs are what grab sauce.

One of the easier shapes, and it tolerates most doughs. The traditional dough is semolina and water, sometimes tinted and flavored with saffron; egg dough gives a lighter result.

This is a strascinati shape, meaning the dough is dragged across a surface rather than rolled or wrapped. It is closer to cavatelli and orecchiette than to potato gnocchi, despite the alias gnocchetti sardi.

No drying step. Refrigerator limit is 24 hours.

Traditional pairing is malloreddus alla campidanese. It also works in a light seafood brodo, with clams, sea beans, and saffron, or in a red sauce with saffron.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____

RATING ____ / 5

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